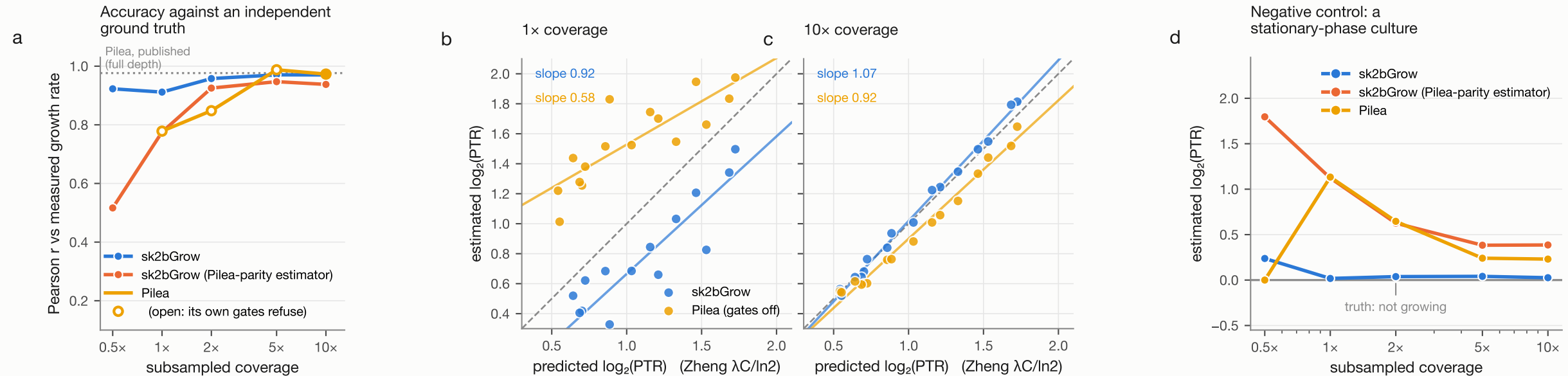




a, Zheng et al. 2020 *E. coli* K-12, 16 growth media ($\lambda = 0.40\text{--}1.72\text{ h}^{-1}$). Pilea at its shipped defaults returns no estimate below 10×; at 0.5× with gates off it returns PTR = 1.0 for every sample, so neither has a defined correlation there.

b, c, Dashed line is $y = x$. A slope below 1 means the PTR range is compressed even where the ranking is correct — which a correlation coefficient hides. The predicted value is not independent: Zheng derived C from this same sequencing by marker-frequency analysis.

d, The sorted-regression estimator reports $\log_2(\text{PTR}) = 1.80$ at 0.5× for a culture that is not growing — it manufactures a gradient out of rank-ordered noise. The coordinate fit stays within 0.24 of zero at every coverage. Pilea reports only at 10× under its own gates; the curve shown has them disabled.